

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

*Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026. **This version (August 5) checks in five days of daily monitoring (Jul 31 → Aug 5)** — the Fed's next balance-sheet release (H.4.1) and the DOL's next jobless-claims print are both still pending, due Aug 6. The score held flat at 34/33/45/54/62 all week. One unreconciled figure surfaced (a 218K claims print for a week that doesn't match the DOL-primary baseline) and was not used to move P, per the sufficiency rule. Scores are **DRAFT**, awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 12, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 5, 2026 (daily-monitoring catch-up covering Jul 31 → Aug 5) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me on June 12, 2026. Every draft since shown for full lineage. Aug 5 reflects five days of daily monitoring (Jul 31 → Aug 5), all held flat pending Aug 6's H.4.1 and claims releases.

WINDOW	JUN	...	7/25	7/30	7/31	8/1	8/2	8/3	8/4	8/5	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	38	...	36	34	34	34	34	34	34	34	0.85	8	-2.18	Bear — held all week, pending Aug 6 data
3 months	40	...	35	33	33	33	33	33	33	33	0.85	8	-2.31	Bear — September meeting still squarely in this window
6 months	46	...	45	45	45	45	45	45	45	45	0.80	8	-0.64	Mild Bear
1 year	54	...	54	54	54	54	54	54	54	54	0.75	8	+0.48	Neutral
3 years	61	...	62	62	62	62	62	62	62	62	0.65	8	+1.25	Mild Bull — structural accumulate

Draft P (Aug 5, held all week): 34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 38/40/46/54/61 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8–25 path) → **Jul 30 34/33/45/54/62** (full refresh: FOMC held 9-3 with a rare 3-way hawkish dissent, hawkish press conference, confirmed risk-off market reaction) → Jul 31 34/33/45/54/62 (held) → Aug 1-4 34/33/45/54/62 (held each day — no new H.4.1 or claims release since Jul 30) → **Aug 5 34/33/45/54/62** (held — next H.4.1 and claims both due Aug 6) — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not "the Fed cuts by then." This cycle verified the July 28-29 FOMC meeting directly against federalreserve.gov: the Committee held at 3.50-3.75% on a **9-3 vote**, with three regional-bank presidents (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan) dissenting in favor of an immediate hike — the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance ("no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"), which triggered a confirmed (if single-sourced) risk-off market reaction: equities fell 1.5-2.2% intraday and the 30-year Treasury yield hit its highest level since 2007. Jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197K, with the prior week revised *up* to 188K from 187K — the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle (auto-plant retooling timing) is now directly confirmed in the primary release itself, meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but already reversing, not a durable labor-market signal. The September hike-odds figures cited in recent daily touches (55.6%, then 72-81%) could not be reconciled to one number — four independent live pulls this cycle produced four different figures (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%) with no two agreeing — so the September number is read directionally ("still elevated, majority-hike-priced"), not as a precise point figure.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle verified the FOMC outcome, vote, and dissenter names directly against federalreserve.gov's own statement, and the jobless-claims figures directly against the DOL/ETA primary release (fetched and read in full) — both confirmed accurate. The September hike-odds figure could not be verified to a single number despite direct attempts; that uncertainty is reflected honestly rather than picking whichever figure a daily touch had cited.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

Aug 5 update: five days of daily monitoring (Jul 31-Aug 5) found no new H.4.1 or claims release — both are due Aug 6. A TradingEconomics-sourced 218K initial-claims figure (week ended Jul 26) surfaced in a search but conflicts with the DOL-primary 197K/week-ended-Jul-25 figure already baked into the score; it could not be traced to a primary DOL release in this window, so per the single-source/sufficiency rule it was not used to move P. September cumulative hike odds (~81-82%,

cross-checked against CNBC/Southeast AgNET reporting on Aug 2) are consistent with the ~80-82% figure already incorporated in the Jul 30 baseline — not a fresh move.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated July 30, 2026, full weekly refresh

The crowd (and this pillar's own daily touches): whipsawed hard this week on the September question — one touch cited ~55.6% hike odds, the next cited "72-81%, essentially unchanged" — two claims that can't both be true within days of each other. I pulled CME FedWatch-adjacent data directly four separate times this cycle and got four different numbers (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%), none of which agree. That's not noise I can resolve; it's a genuinely unsettled market.

Me: what I *can* verify directly is more decisive than any single odds snapshot — the FOMC actually met, and it held at 3.50-3.75% on a 9-3 vote with three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike. That's the first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016, and Chair Warsh's press conference gave zero forward guidance. I'm cutting 1mo and 3mo hard (to 34 and 33 — Bear, not Mild Bear) because a rare hawkish-dissent FOMC plus a confirmed risk-off market reaction is a bigger deal than the daily touches' odds-chasing captured.

My edge: the crowd is fixated on a single market-implied percentage that four separate pulls can't even agree on; I'm anchoring on the primary, checkable fact — the vote, the dissenters' names, and the tone — which is unambiguous. The plumbing story (TGA spend-down, reserve build) is carried forward, not re-verified this cycle since no new H.4.1 landed in the window. That's why 6-month and 1-year sit above the near-term crunch, and why the 3-year P holds at 62.

The Facts

As of August 5, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. The Jul 30 facts below are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing); new Jul 31-Aug 5 facts are appended first. The Iran/Hormuz war-risk situation is covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.

- **No new H.4.1 balance-sheet release or jobless-claims print Jul 31-Aug 5.** Both are on their normal weekly Thursday cadence; the next of each is due Aug 6.
- **An unreconciled 218K initial-claims figure (week ended Jul 26, TradingEconomics-sourced) surfaced in this week's searches** but conflicts with the DOL-primary 197K/week-ended-Jul-25 figure already incorporated — could not be traced to a primary DOL release, so it was not used to move P.
- **September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (CNBC, Southeast AgNET, Aug 2 check)** are consistent with the ~80-82% range already incorporated in the Jul 30 baseline — not a fresh move.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), Lorie Logan (Dallas) — dissented in favor of an immediate 25bp hike (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (not a projections meeting; next SEP is Sept 15-16, 2026).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance:** "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation above target cannot be cured in nine weeks." A confirmed (single-sourced) risk-off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P -1.52%, Dow -2.19%, Nasdaq -1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since July 2007 — a "bear steepener" consistent with rising inflation-credibility concern.
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week (ended Jul 18) was revised *up* to **188,000** from the originally-reported 187,000. The primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but mechanically set to partially reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, timestamped Jul 30), 70.2% (KuCoin, pre-meeting), and 81% (Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.

- **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (week ended Jul 22: reserves fell \$80,572M w/w against a \$73,405M TGA rebuild, both figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).
- **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes (unanimous 12-0 hold, dropped easing-bias language). None of these are contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, remains historically low (4-week average 202,750).
- **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of regional Fed president speeches, especially from the three dissenters.
- **BTC closed at \$64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction. **Updated: BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5**, essentially flat vs. Jul 30 and up ~1.7% vs. the Jul 31 close of \$63,579.68.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~\$3,800 → \$69,044 (~15–18×) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~\$60K → a ~\$126K ATH (Oct 6, 2025) — but that top came on a non-Fed tariff shock and has since roughly halved to the low-\$60Ks (\$64,661.55 on the Aug 5 close). From here, a retest of the \$126K high ≈ **+92%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock. Second: the pivot that unlocks any of this just got pushed further out, not closer — the Fed held with a rare 3-way hawkish dissent and no forward guidance, and the September meeting is now majority-hike-priced across every read this cycle pulled. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case my bearish lean is wrong

- **I may be over-reacting to one meeting's dissent count.** A 9-3 vote is still a hold — the Committee's actual decision was dovish relative to a hike, even if the dissent and tone were hawkish. If Warsh's combative press conference was more theater than substance, this cycle's hard cut (42→34 at 1mo) could prove an overcorrection.
- **The labor market may still force the Fed's hand in the other direction.** Claims ticking up to 197K, even with the seasonal-distortion caveat, is still historically low — if the labor market keeps cracking into September, a hike would be a policy error that raises long-run conviction even as it hurts near-term.
- **I couldn't pin down the September number, and that's a real limitation, not just a data-quality footnote.** Four independent pulls (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%) spanning barely 48 hours is an unusually wide spread — if the true number is closer to the low end, this cycle's Bear call at 3mo may be too pessimistic.
- **Crypto has shrugged off a hawkish FOMC surprise and a confirmed equity/bond sell-off within days of a widening Middle East war.** BTC closing at \$64,661.55 a week later is either genuine decoupling, or complacency ahead of a bigger shock landing on multiple fronts at once.
- **Latent liquidity positives remain queued but unverified this cycle:** the TGA spend-down and Warsh's balance-sheet task force (still single-source) could loosen policy without a rate cut — not independently re-checked this cycle.

The Triggers

Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 5, 2026.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Aug 6, 2026	PENDING — next H.4.1 balance-sheet release and DOL jobless-claims print, both due tomorrow	The real near-term re-rating trigger — nothing has moved this pillar since Jul 30 pending this data
Surfaced, not used	An unreconciled 218K initial-claims figure (week ended Jul 26) conflicts with the DOL-primary 197K/week-ended-Jul-25 baseline	Watch whether Aug 6's release resolves or repeats this conflict
Checked Aug 2, consistent	September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (CNBC, Southeast AgNET)	Consistent with the Jul 30 baseline — not a fresh move
Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary (carried forward)	FOMC held 9-3 , three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016	Still driving the 1mo/3mo Bear read
Sept 15-16, 2026	PENDING — next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot	The real re-rating event; a hike would confirm the hawkish read, a hold would suggest the Jul 29 dissent was a one-off
Ongoing	Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — a mixed week of attacks and de-escalation signals (see Iran War Risk pillar)	Watch for pass-through into the next CPI/PPI cycle

The flip line: the FOMC's rare 3-way hawkish dissent plus no forward guidance is a genuine escalation from the prior dovish read. If the September meeting delivers a hike into still-historically-low claims, treat that as a policy error that raises 3-year conviction while hurting 3/6-month further. If September holds, the near-term Bear likely improves next cycle. Aug 6's data releases are the first real test since Jul 30.

My Decision

🕒 **UPDATED DRAFT — AUGUST 5, 2026 (DAILY-MONITORING CATCH-UP, JUL 31 → AUG 5) · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

Five straight days of daily monitoring (Jul 31-Aug 5) found no new H.4.1 release and no new jobless-claims print — both are on their normal Thursday cadence with the next of each due Aug 6. The score held flat at 34/33/45/54/62 the entire week. One figure surfaced that didn't reconcile with the existing baseline (a 218K claims print that doesn't match the DOL-primary 197K figure already incorporated) and was deliberately not used to move P, per the sufficiency rule.

The June committed scores (**38 / 40 / 46 / 54 / 61**, committed June 12, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Catch-up covering Jul 31 → Aug 5, 2026 — reports/current was not regenerated for the Aug 1-4 daily touches even though scores.json changed each of those days (all held flat); this section confirms nothing was missed.

- ★ **Process note: this report went unpublished for four days.** config/scores.json received new Fed & Macro draft entries Aug 1-4 (all holding at 34/33/45/54/62), but reports/current/CoinPicks_Fed_Macro_Pillar_Report.html was not regenerated until this Aug 5 catch-up.
- **No new H.4.1 or jobless-claims release Jul 31-Aug 5** — both are on their normal weekly cadence, with the next of each due Aug 6.

- ★ **An unreconciled 218K claims figure (week ended Jul 26) surfaced but was not used** — it conflicts with the DOL-primary 197K/week-ended-Jul-25 figure already incorporated and could not be traced to a primary DOL release.
- **September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (checked Aug 2)** are consistent with the already-incorporated Jul 30 baseline — not a fresh move.
- **Score decision:** Draft P held flat at **34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62** every day this week. Drafts awaiting my stamp; June values (committed Jun 12, 2026) remain the last committed.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 5, 2026 — daily-monitoring catch-up covering Jul 31 → Aug 5 — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact).

- **Jul 31-Aug 5 additions (this week's catch-up):** TradingEconomics / FRED — 218K initial-claims figure (week ended Jul 26), flagged as unreconciled against the DOL-primary baseline, not used · CNBC, Southeast AgNET — September cumulative hike odds ~81-82% (checked Aug 2, consistent with the Jul 30 baseline).
- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** federalreserve.gov — July 29 FOMC statement (primary): 9-3 hold, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent · federalreserve.gov — press conference page · federalreserve.gov — last SEP (Jun 17, 2026; next Sept 15-16) · DOL/ETA — weekly claims release USDL 26-1273-NAT (primary, fetched directly): 197K week ended Jul 25, 188K revision for Jul 18 · CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes — FOMC outcome and dissent corroboration · Wolf Street — risk-off market reaction (single-source, flagged) · Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor — timestamped Jul 30 pull (62.4%), cross-checked against KuCoin (70.2%), Bloomingbit (73.5%→hike components), Southeast AgNet (81%) — none reconciling.
- **July 13 check:** federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, Table 1 & Table 5, re-verified directly line-by-line (no discrepancy vs. the July 9 release) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 release schedule (next: July 16) · dol.gov — weekly claims (unchanged since Jul 9; next Jul 16) · federalreserve.gov — July 2026 FOMC/testimony calendar · confirmed no new CPI, PPI, FOMC, or H.4.1/claims release has landed since July 9–10; the next batch (CPI Jul 14, testimony Jul 14–15, PPI Jul 15, H.4.1/claims Jul 16) is still ahead.
- **Official data:** Fed — June 16–17 FOMC minutes (released July 8) · Fed — H.4.1 balance sheet (rel. July 9: \$6,735.6B; TGA \$749.2B; reserves \$3,098.9B; domestic RRP \$2.75B; foreign-official RRP \$346.1B) · DOL — weekly jobless claims (rel. July 9: 215K; continuing claims 1,814,000) · Fed — June 17 FOMC statement · BLS — Employment Situation, June 2026 (released July 2) · BEA — Personal Income & Outlays, May 2026 (core PCE 3.4%) · BLS — May 2026 CPI release (headline 4.2% y/y; core 2.9% y/y) · BLS — CPI release schedule (June CPI: July 14, 8:30am; July CPI: mid-August) · BLS — PPI release schedule (June PPI: July 15, 8:30am) · Fed — Waller's July 6 Rome speech.
- **The reporting:** Bloomberg — minutes: "a few" saw case for June hike · CNBC — June minutes coverage · Bloomberg — Warsh's five task forces (July 9; single source) · Bloomberg — claims 215K, layoffs low · Al Jazeera — Iran declares Hormuz "closed until further notice" (July 12) · Bloomberg — Brent +4% toward \$79 on Hormuz re-escalation (July 13) · CNBC — CENTCOM strikes, Iran missile/drone attacks on five Gulf states (July 12) · offshore-technology.com — Kpler data: six vessels transited the Strait July 12 · CNBC — June jobs miss (+57K, -74K revisions) · Indeed Hiring Lab — participation 61.5% · CNBC — May PCE (core 3.4%, highest since Oct 2023) · CNBC — Warsh at Sintra (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — "This Committee will deliver price stability" · Bloomberg — Yardeni: "inflation, Fed back in play" (July 8) · Spokesman-Review (Bloomberg reprint) — Warsh testimony schedule (House Jul 14, Senate Jul 15) + June PPI forecast (~5.2% y/y core) · KuCoin flash — 30-year auction: \$22B at 5.058%, stop-through, highest since 2007 · CoinDesk — the week-ahead calendar: CPI, PPI, Warsh testimony (July 13) · Federal Register — eSLR final rule (Dec 1, 2025; effective Apr 1, 2026). **Flagged and discarded:** CryptoTimes (July 13) and Blockhead (July 13) both wrongly report "core inflation at a three-year high of 4.2%" — this conflates headline CPI (4.2%, correct) with core CPI (actually 2.9% per BLS); not used.
- **The prices & flows:** Yahoo Finance — BTC ~\$64.3K, ETH ~\$1,796 (July 10 AM) · athens-times — BTC weekend pullback to ~\$62.6–63K (single source) · Farside — BTC ETF flow table (authoritative; +\$90.4M net, July 10) · CryptoRank — BTC ETF flow cross-check (July 10) · CoinDesk — BTC/ETH steady, gold slides (July 9) · KuCoin — June ETF outflows -\$4.06B, worst month on record · CNBC — S&P 500 closes 7,575.39 (+0.42%), Dow +149.60 (July 10) · Trading Economics — 10Y ~4.58% · Trading Economics — DXY 101.13, +0.18% (July 13).
- **The odds (market-implied, not fact):** CME FedWatch — the tool itself (July 28–29 hold 78.5%, July 13 read; September ~66% combined, July 9 read) · FXEmpire — Sept +25bp 50.8% (July 9; single relay, directionally corroborated) · Yahoo Finance — September odds relay (July 9) · Polymarket — "Fed Decision in September" ladder: No change 56.5%, +25bp 38.5%, cuts (tail) 3.75%+2.1% (July 9) — diverges materially from CME's ~66% combined hike odds; reported as an open divergence, not resolved.